

Restoration Ethics Studio Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 30-40 min

Category	The Arts	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	restoration-ethics-studio

Big idea: Preserving an artwork can also alter what future viewers know through it.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Scenario: a mural has faded paint, later graffiti, and a damaged corner. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Options: clean only, repaint invisibly, preserve damage, add a modern label, commission a visible repair. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Restoration Ethics Studio Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Options: clean only, repaint invisibly, preserve damage, add a modern label, commission a visible repair. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Preserving an artwork can also alter what future viewers know through it.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	Does restoration preserve knowledge or create new meaning?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Scenario: a mural has faded paint, later graffiti, and a damaged corner.
- Options: clean only, repaint invisibly, preserve damage, add a modern label, commission a visible repair.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Activity Steps

1. Present a fictional damaged artwork and its background.
2. Groups inspect restoration options and stakeholder priorities.
3. Students choose a restoration plan and justify it with evidence and values.
4. Groups compare how each plan changes authenticity and viewer knowledge.
5. Debrief whether preservation can be a form of interpretation.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: Does restoration preserve knowledge or create a new object of knowledge?
- What counts as authenticity in the arts?
- Who should decide how an artwork is preserved?

Knowledge Questions

- Does restoration preserve knowledge or create new meaning?
- What counts as authenticity in the arts?
- How do values shape artistic knowledge?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with a damaged artwork with choices to preserve, restore, reinterpret, or leave visible. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...